

Small Type And Alias Text

 When working with small type (10 points or smaller), the text might become difficult to read because of the anti-aliasing that is automatically applied to vector shapes in Flash MX 2004. Anti-aliasing is a blurring, or 'smoothening', of the edges of vector shapes and text. Often, anti-aliasing adds to the quality of the shape, but small text may become unreadable.

In Flash MX 2004, Macromedia has added a new 'Alias Text' button that allows you to alias blocks of type, thereby increasing readability.

The alias text feature can be applied to Static, Dynamic, and Input text fields. However, if a visitor to your Web site does not have version 7 (or higher) of the Flash plug-in, they will only see aliased Static text. If you are using any Dynamic or Input text fields with the Alias text feature, viewers with older versions of the Flash plug-in will still see that text as anti-aliased.

Improve Bitmap Quality

 To improve the image quality of bitmaps before and after importing them to Flash:

Don't scale imported bitmaps within Flash. This greatly reduces image quality. Instead, use an external image editor such as Macromedia Fireworks to scale the image to the desired pixel dimensions before import.

After importing an image into Flash, break it apart and convert it to a graphic symbol. To do this, first, select the image and go to Modify>Break Apart. Now, with the image still selected, go to Insert>Convert to Symbol, and select the 'Graphic' option for the behaviour.

In the HTML tab of the Publish Settings (File>Publish Settings>HTML) set the 'Quality' to 'Best'. Disable the 'Allow Smoothing' option for the bitmap. In the 'Library' window, right-click on the bitmap and select 'Properties'. Uncheck 'Allow Smoothing' in the 'Properties' dialog and click 'OK'.



Use lossless compression for the bitmap. In the 'Library' window, right-click on the bitmap and select 'Properties'. Choose 'Lossless' from the 'Compression' pop-up menu and click 'OK'. This will cause Flash to render the image at the original imported quality, but will probably cause the .SWF file size to increase considerably.

_root.goto!

 Here's the code for a button placed inside a movie clip, which will give the instruction 'Go to and play' a certain frame in the root movie, and not the clip the button resides in.

```
_root.gotoAndPlay(frame);
eg:
on (release) {
  _root.gotoAndStop(10);
}
```

Disable The Hand Cursor

 Create your button as you normally would. Give your button an instance name like "digit" in the 'Properties' panel.

In the timeline, click on the first frame your button is placed on and open the Actions panel ([F9])

```
Enter this ActionScript:
digit.useHandCursor =
false;
```

Disable A Button

 Create a button normally. Name the

button in the 'Properties' panel, say, "digit". Left-click on the button to select it, and open the Actions panel ([F9])

```
Enter this ActionScript:
on (release) {
  digit.enabled = false;
}
```

If you want to enable the button later, change "false" to "true".

Here Comes The Easter Bunny!

 Here's how you can see an Easter Egg in Flash MX 2004:

Go to "Help/About Flash Professional...", and click on the tiny "TM" symbol near the number 2004. Enjoy!

Matching The Size Of The Object

 To fit the background/stage to the selected object, place the object on the top left hand corner of the stage. Now, go to Modify>Document Properties>Match>Contents. Remember, this will work only if the object is placed on the top left hand corner of the stage.

Customising commands

 Flash 2004 Professional (Window>Other panels>History), which documents the history of your previous actions. To save particular actions as a new

command, select the desired action, right-click on the action and choose 'Save As Command'. You can also name the new command and view it in the Commands menu. These new commands can be repeated, as and when required. Commands can directly be accessed from the Command menu as well.

Dreamweaver MX

Indent Text Without Using Blockquotes

 Thus far, there have been two methods used to indent text-using the <BLOCKQUOTE> tag or by placing text in the second cell of a two-column table. Using cascading-style sheets, you now have a better alternative:

Cascading style sheets allow you to specify the exact indentation for your text. For example, to indent all text using the <P> tag, choose Text>Custom Style>Edit Style Sheet. In the dialog box that pops up, choose 'New'. Now, select 'Redefine HTML Tag', choose 'P' from the list and click 'OK'.

In the 'Style Definition' dialog box, choose 'Box' and enter the desired indent span (in pixels) in the left text field of the 'Margin' section. Finally, click 'OK' and then 'Done' to return to your HTML document. As you will see, any text wrapped in the paragraph tag (<p>) is set to an indent. The definition of the new Paragraph style will look like:

```
<STYLE TYPE="TEXT/CSS">
<!--
p { margin-left: 25px }
-->
</STYLE>
```

Clean Up Word HTML Documents

 Microsoft Word can save documents in HTML format. However, the HTML, XML, and CSS (Cascading Style Sheets) code that Word generates is geared more to format and display documents in Word than in a Web browser. Because of its complexity, it's a good idea to clean up Word-generated HTML code.

Fortunately, Dreamweaver can instantly remove the unnecessary Word-generated